



Vocals and instruments sound clean in my favourite: Hurt by Johnny Cash. I could even hear some scratch-like artefact towards the song's climax, which speaks to the headphone's resolving ability. Similarly, I could hear tiny details clearly in Far From Road by

Handsome Family. And the openness of the sound is quite evident in Heart-breaker by the Rolling Stones.

The bass extension in songs like Breathe Into Me by Marian Hill or desi hip hop tracks by Seedhe Maut or Krsna slaps, but it is not very deep or overpowering.

It feels fairly controlled with some vibrations, which keeps things from getting muddy.

The high portion in songs like Dawn of the Iconoclast by Dead Can Dance sounds detailed and listenable, never veering into harsh or fatiguing territory.

Besides music, the sound was clear and quick for solo games. For multi-player gaming, you'll need a cable with a mic. And in case you intend to use it for some casual editing, a colleague of mine used it to edit some videos and said it was working just fine.

SHOULD YOU BUY THE PHILIPS SHP9500?

There are not many open-back headphones in the sub-Rs 7,000 price segment. And at its street price, the Philips SHP9500 can be a good entry to this headphone category. It is comfortable to wear, easy to use, sounds clear and raw. For the price of Rs 6,499, it is a really good purchase.

But if you want a mic input and don't have any lying around, then you will have to make an additional investment. And if you don't like the open-back form factor, the associated compromises in sound leakage, or the wired design, then you can look elsewhere.

So, for those looking for wired open-back over-ear headphones from a reputed brand at around Rs 6,000 to Rs 7,000, this Philips pair is something that is worth checking out.

—G. S. Vasan

SPECIFICATIONS

Acoustic system: Open-back | Magnet type: Neodymium | Impedance: 32 Ohm | Sensitivity: 101 dB | Speaker Diameter: 50mm | Frequency response: 12 - 35k Hz | Power input: 200 mW | Connector: 3.5 mm | Cable: 1.5 m detachable cable | Weight: 300g

CONTACT

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